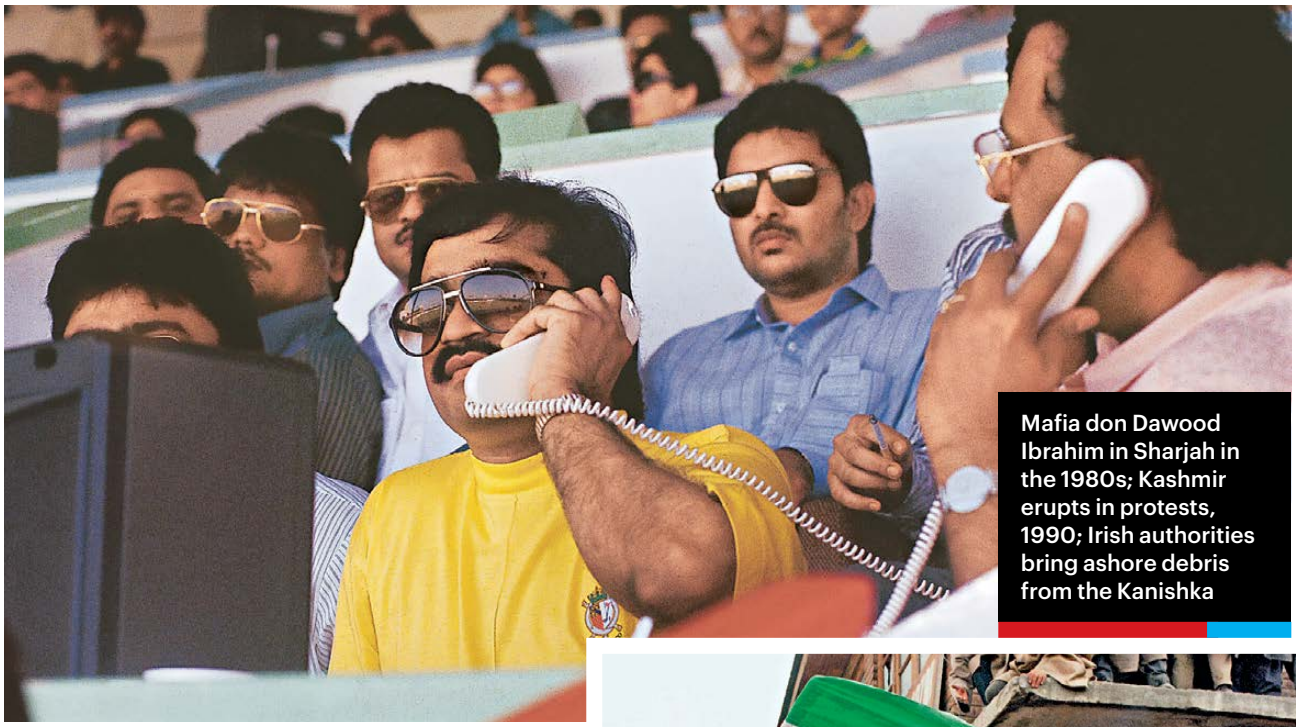
BHAWAN SINGH



Mafia don Dawood Ibrahim in Sharjah in the 1980s; Kashmir erupts in protests, 1990; Irish authorities bring ashore debris from the Kanishka

NO

major nation ever writes its history without traumatic passages penned in blood and cordite, but outside of wars, it's perhaps rare for one decade to contain events of such a cataclysmic nature, that too on such disparate fronts, all of them leaving profound and lingering effects. From assassinations to riots, bomb blasts to social conflagrations, the 1985-95 phase held India in a miasma of dread intense even by its sanguinary standards. Here's a limited doomscroll:

Kanishka bombing, June 23, 1985: A documentary or two and one dark comedy, all in Canada. Besides that, "the world's deadliest act of aviation terrorism until September 11" has received a lot of amnesia. All 329 people on board were killed when Khalistani terrorists blew apart Air India Flight 182 in mid-air. After a prolonged trial with meagre returns—one conviction—the attack has receded to become a point of diplomatic contretemps between India and Canada.

"THE WORLD'S DEADLIEST ACT OF AVIATION TERROR"—UNTIL 9/11—THE MID-AIR KANISHKA BOMBING IS STILL A NARRATIVE WITH LOOSE ENDS



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